

1 What is QVD in Qlik Sense?

QVD is Qlik's native, optimized data-storage format, primarily used to store extracted/transformed data and improve reload performance, reduce source-system load, and support incremental loading.

2 type of load

Load type	Purpose

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LOAD	Load data from a file/table/result
Resident Load	Load data from an already loaded table
Preceding Load	Transform data before loading into the final table
Binary Load	Load the data model from another Qlik app
Inline Load	Create small data directly inside the script
Autogenerate	Generate records without an external data source
Crosstable Load	Convert cross-tab/pivot-style data into normalized rows
Generic Load	Handle attribute-value/pivot-style data
Mapping Load	Create a mapping table for lookups/replacements
Join Load	Join one table with another
Concatenate Load	Append records to another table
Keep Load	Reduce tables based on matching keys without physically joining them

3 1. What is a Synthetic Key?

A Synthetic Key is automatically created by Qlik Sense when two or more tables have two or more common field names.

However, an unnecessary or complex synthetic key can cause:

- Poor application performance
- Increased memory consumption
- Complex data model
- Unexpected associations
- Incorrect results in some data models

Method 1 – Rename fields

Method 2 – Remove unnecessary fields

Method 3 – Create a Composite Key

4 what is loop

When there is more than one possible path to travel from one table to another, Qlik can create a circular relationship called a loop.

2. Rename unrelated fields

3. Remove unnecessary associations

4. Create a Link Table

5 Qlik Sense is a modern self-service Business Intelligence and data visualization platform used to load, associate, analyze, and visualize data through interactive dashboards and reports.

Associative Engine – explores relationships between data.

Data Integration – connects to databases, files, APIs, etc.

Visualization – charts, KPIs, tables, maps.

Self-Service BI – business users can explore data without heavy coding.

Interactive Analysis – selections dynamically update relate

6 “QlikView is mainly used for developer-built, guided BI applications, whereas Qlik Sense focuses on self-service, interactive analytics and modern cloud-based BI.”

what is associated model

The Associative Model is Qlik Sense's data model that automatically associates related tables through common field names, allowing users to explore data across different dimensions without predefined drill-down paths.

7 what is Associative Search

Searches across the entire associative data model.

Example:

Search John

Qlik can find matching values across fields such as Customer Name, Employee Name, Salesperson, etc.

8 What is Smart Search

The global search feature that lets users search across the application and associated data.

9 color code in associated search

Color	Meaning
 **Green**	**Selected values**
 **White**	**Possible values**
 **Gray**	**Excluded values**
 **Yellow**	**Alternative values**

10 What is an App in Qlik Sense? – Interview Answer

A Qlik Sense App is a container that contains the data model, load script, sheets, visualizations, dimensions, measures, and business logic used to analyze data.

11 Qlik Sense Hub

The user-facing portal.

Users use the Hub to:

- Open apps
- Create apps
- View sheets
- Analyze dashboards
- Access shared/managed content

12 Qlik Engine Service

“The Qlik Engine is responsible for loading data into memory and performing associative calculations and analytics.”

13 Qlik Repository Service (QRS)

“QRS manages the metadata and configuration of the Qlik Sense environment.”

14 Qlik Management Console (QMC)

“QMC is the administration interface used to configure and manage the Qlik Sense environment.”

15 data manager

Data Manager is a user-friendly interface in Qlik Sense that allows users to load, prepare, associate, and manage data without writing much scripting code.

16 data load editor

Data Load Editor is a script-based development environment in Qlik Sense used to load, transform, and prepare data using Qlik scripting language.

17 data model

A Qlik Sense Data Model is the structure that defines how different tables are loaded and associated with each other using common fields. It is used by the Qlik Associative Engine to connect and analyze data.

18 snapshot

A Snapshot in Qlik Sense is a static copy of a visualization at a particular point in time, used mainly when creating stories.

19 Qlik Sense Stories is a presentation feature used to present and communicate insights from your data using snapshots of visualizations.

20 alternative state

“Alternate State in Qlik Sense allows us to maintain independent selections within the same app, mainly to compare different selections such as Region A vs Region B or Year 2024 vs Year 2025.”

21 what is calculated dimension

A Calculated Dimension is a dimension created using a Qlik expression instead of directly using a field from the data model.

22 difference between sum and aggr

Sum() is an aggregation function used to calculate the total of a numeric field, while Aggr() is a nested aggregation function that first calculates an expression at a specified

dimension level and then allows another aggregation on that result.

Aggr(Sum(Sales), Customer)

23 what is auto generate

AutoGenerate is a Qlik script feature used to automatically generate a specified number of rows without requiring an external data source.

24 ApplyMap() is a Qlik Sense function used to look up a value from a mapping table and return the corresponding value.

24 Join vs Concatenate vs Keep in Qlik Sense

JOIN = combine columns

CONCATENATE = combine rows

KEEP = filter/associate tables without physically joining them

25 NoConcatenate is a Qlik Sense script prefix used to prevent automatic concatenation of two tables that have the same field structure.

26 Link table

A Link Table is a separate table used to connect multiple fact tables through common dimensions, especially when the fact tables have different sets of keys.

27 3. What is a Bookmark?

A Bookmark saves a particular selection state of an app.

28 How do you improve Qlik Sense App Performance?

"I improve Qlik Sense application performance by reducing the amount of data loaded, optimizing the data model, using QVDs, minimizing expensive calculations, avoiding synthetic keys and circular references, optimizing expressions, and reducing the number of unnecessary visualizations."

28. Why do we use Set Analysis?

We use Set Analysis when we want a calculation to consider a specific set of records, independent of or in addition to the user's current selections.

Common use cases:

Current Year Sales

Previous Year Sales

YTD Sales

MTD Sales

Sales for a particular region

Sales excluding a particular region

Market Share

\$ represents the current selection state.

1 represents the entire data set, ignoring the current selections.

\$1 represents the previous selection state.

\$2 Selection before \$1

\$0 – Current Selection?

+= – Add Values In Set Analysis, += is used with a field assignment to add values to the existing set.

Sum(<{<Region += {'South'}}> Sales)

Keep the existing Region values and add South.

-= removes values from the existing set.

Sum(<{<Region -= {'South'}}> Sales)

Keep the existing Region selection, but remove South.

Most important examples

Sum(Sales)

☞ Current selection

Sum({\$} Sales)

☞ Current selection

Sum({1} Sales)

☞ All data

Sum({\$1} Sales)

☞ Previous selection

Sum(<{<Region={'South'}}> Sales)

☞ Replace Region with South

Sum(<{<Region += {'South'}}> Sales)

☞ Add South

Sum(<{<Region -= {'South'}}> Sales)

☞ Remove South

Interview shortcut:

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Qlik Answers is a GenAI-powered conversational assistant in Qlik Cloud that allows users to ask natural-language questions and receive answers, insights, charts, and sheets from structured and unstructured data.

Qlik Assist is Qlik's AI-powered conversational analytics assistant. It allows users to ask questions about their business data using natural language instead of manually building charts or writing expressions.

Simple example

Suppose your Qlik Sense app contains sales data.

You can ask:

"What are the total sales by region?"

Qlik Assist can understand the question and provide an analytical response, such as a chart or table.

You can then ask:

"Which region has the highest sales?"

A Qlik Knowledge Base is a collection of documents and information that Qlik Assist can use as a source of knowledge when answering questions.

Think of it as giving Qlik Assist a company-specific knowledge library.

Simple example

Suppose your company has these PDF documents:

Sales_Policy.pdf
Product_Catalog.pdf
Company_FAQ.pdf
Customer_Return_Policy.pdf

You can add these documents to a Knowledge Base.